Diploma in

PHOTOSHOP

SUMMARY NOTES

The Power of Selection Tools

Lesson 4

BEFORE WE PROCEED TO CREATE AMAZING COMPOSITES, WE MUST FIRST UNDERSTAND HOW SELECTIONS CAN BE USED TO EDIT OUR IMAGES. USING OUR SELECTION TOOLS ENABLES US TO CREATE CHANGES TO SPECIFIC PARTS OF OUR IMAGES. COMBINE ALL THE INFORMATION WE HAVE LEARNED SO FAR, WITH THE VARIETY OF SELECTION TOOLS AVAILABLE AND WE ARE ONE STEP CLOSER TO MAKING PICTURES PERFECT.

4.01 Selection Tools

4.02 Tool Types

LESSON 4

SELECTION TOOLS

"If you are using the Rectangle Marquee tool, the Elliptical Marquee tool, or the Lasso tool, click. anywhere in the image outside the selected area and your pixels will automatically be deselected. ."

Selection Tools allow us to isolate areas of our image and apply adjustments to these selected areas only. A selection simply isolates one or more parts of your image. By selecting specific areas, you can edit and apply effects and adjustments to portions of your image while leaving the unselected areas untouched.

Photoshop shows us which area is selected by a flashing dotted line. This flashing line used to indicate the selection you have made is known as 'marching ants'. This is due to the movement of the line. We can also use selection tools to copy a certain area of our image and paste it into another one to create an image composite.

We have a range of options when using selections:

- To deselect pixels at any point simply choose **Select> Deselect.**
- We can invert a selection using **Select>Inverse.**
- We can transform a selection wiling **Select>Transform Selection.**
- We can soften the edges of our selections using the Feather option.
- Selections work With all other tools, helping you constrain the tools to "Draw inside the lines" in a way.
- Selections work with adjustments and masking also.

TOOL TYPES

Rectangular Marquee Tool allows us to select rectangles and squares.

Elliptical Marquee Tool allows us to select ellipse shapes.

- To make a perfect circle hold down shift key while you click and drag.
- To draw ellipse out from the middle, click and hold alt/option key.

Lasso Tool is a free form drawing tool. It allows us to draw irregular shapes. Simple click and drag wherever you want the selection to go.

Polygonal Lasso Tool draws a point to point line around our subject. It can only draw straight lines.

- To delete a point, you can use the backspace key on your keyboard.

Magic Wand Tool is a very old tool. Nicknamed the 'tragic wand tool'. Uses contrast detection to make selections. Selects pixels similar in colour to the pixel on which you originally clicked on with the tool.

- *The Tolerance option tells Photoshop how different in tone and colour a pixel can be from the area we clicked on for it to be included in the selection. By default, the Tolerance value is set to 32, which means that Photoshop will select any pixels that are the same colour as the area we clicked on, plus any pixels that are up to 32 shades darker or 32 shades brighter.*
- *Contiguous: Only pixels connected to the spot by pixels of the same colour are selected.*

Quick Selection Tool allows us to quickly "paint" a selection using an adjustable round brush tip. As you drag, the selection expands outward and automatically finds and follows defined edges in the image.

- *Tool uses contrast detection so sometimes doesn't work with blurred or low contrast images.*

All Tool Tips

- We can make our brush larger/smaller and harder/softer using the Options panel.
- We can use our square bracket keys as a shortcut to make brush larger/smaller.
- The Shift key allows us to add to the selection.
- The Alt/Option key will remove from the selection.
- Anti-Alias should be turned on for smoother selections.

4.03

The Power of Selection Tools

THANK YOU